Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

By Lewis Carroll

Chapter I: Down the Rabbit-Hole

Alice is reading a book, flipping through the pages rapidly and is bored. (Actor simulates the passing of time by pantomiming the movements of a clock with sound effects)

ALICE: *(Sighs heavily as she closes the book)* What is the use of a book without pictures or conversations! *(Suddenly a white rabbit catches her attention)*

WHITE RABBIT: Oh, dear! Oh, dear! I shall be too late!" *(he takes a watch out of his pocket, looks at it and hurries on. Alice follows.)* Oh my ears and whiskers, how late it's getting! [Rabbit Hole!] *(He jumps down the hole and Alice follows. As she lands, the rabbit is no longer in sight. She finds herself in a hall with a serious of doors. She tries each door)*

DOOR #1: Locked

DOOR #2: Locked

DOOR #3: Locked

ALICE: [Oh, look] a tiny golden key. *(Picks it up)* It might belong to one of the doors!

DOOR #1: Too small

DOOR #2: [Nope]

DOOR #3: *(Simply laughs)*

ALICE: Either the locks [are] too large, or the key [is] too small.

SMALL DOOR: *(representing a small door – makes some type of sound to get Alice's attention)*

ALICE: A little door! *(She tries the little key in the lock and it fits!)* [Oh, look] the loveliest garden you ever saw. Bright flowers . . . fountains! *(She tries to fit her head in the doorway, but she's much too big)* Oh, how I wish I could shut up like a telescope! I think I could, if I only knew how to begin.

BOTTLE: Drink Me!

ALICE: [Well, I'm certainly] not going to do that in a hurry. I'll look first and see whether it's marked "Poison" or not. *(Alice examines the bottle)*

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BOTTLE: Drink Me! *(Alice shrugs her shoulders and took a sip)*

ALICE: What a curious feeling! *(Alice shrinks down to 10-inches high, quickly tries the key in the lock. It works and she swings open the door)*

NARRATOR: Wonderland! *(As Alice steps through the doorway, trumpets blare to herald her arrival)*

ALICE: Curiouser and curiouser!

INTRODUCTION

In 1865 a novel was written that would change the face of children's literature. In fact, Alice in Wonderland's themes and characters are so bizarre that in the 1960's rumors began to surface that Lewis Carroll wrote the book under the influence of drugs. It's a tempting theory – after all the story has Alice eating 'magic' mushrooms and meeting hookah smoking caterpillars. Reference to this seminal work appear in modern day films like The Matrix: "You take the blue pill . . . The story ends, you wake up in your bed and believe whatever you want to believe. You take the red pill . . . You stay in Wonderland, and I show you how deep the rabbit hole goes."

Alice in Wonderland by Lewis Carroll . . . No pills or mushrooms required.

Chapter V: Advice from a Caterpillar

ALICE: [What a] large mushroom . . . Caterpillar!

CATERPILLAR: *(taking a hookah from its mouth)* Who are you?

ALICE: I – I hardly know, sir, just at the present – at least I know who I was when I got up this morning, but I think I must have changed several times since then.

CATERPILLAR: What do you mean? Explain yourself!

ALICE: I can't explain myself, I'm afraid, sir, because I'm not myself, you see?

CATERPILLAR: I don't see!

ALICE: *(losing her temper)* I'm afraid I can't put it more clearly – Being so many different sizes in a day is very confusing!

CATERPILLAR: Keep your temper! . . . So you think you're changed, do you? What size do you want to be?

ALICE: Well, I should like to be a little larger, sir – three inches is such a wretched height to be.

CATERPILLAR: One side of the mushroom will make you grow taller, and the other side will make you grow shorter. *(He disappears in a puff of smoke)*

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ALICE: *(Alice stretches her arms round the mushroom as far as they will go and breaks off a bit with each hand)* And now . . . which is which . . . *(she takes a bite of one of the pieces and begins to grow)* [Ahhh. . .] Back to my right size! The next thing is to get into that beautiful garden! *(Alice walks for a bit and comes to a small house)*

CHAPTER VI: Pig and Pepper

ALICE: Cheshire Cat! Would you tell me please, which way I ought to walk from here?

CHESHIRE CAT: That depends a good deal on where you want to get to. In that direction *(waiving its right paw round)* lives a Hatter: and in that direction *(waving the other paw)* lives a March Hare. Visit either you like: they're both mad.

ALICE: But I don't want to go among mad people.

CHESHIRE CAT: Oh, you can't help that. We're all mad here. I'm mad. You're mad.

ALICE: How do you know I'm mad?

CHESHIRE CAT: You must be or you wouldn't have come here. . . Do you play croquet with the Queen today?

ALICE: I should like it very much, but I haven't been invited y et.

CHESHIRE CAT: You'll see me there! *(and he vanishes)*

ALICE: [Well], I've seen hatters before. The March Hare will be much the most interesting and perhaps as this is May it won't be raving mad – at least not so mad as it was in March. *(Hatter enters. He pours himself some tea, and follows Alice for a few seconds, establishing character, and then speaks)*

CHAPTER VII: A Mad Tea-Party

HATTER: No room!

MARCH HARE: No room!

ALICE: There's plenty of room! It's laid for a great many more than three!

HATTER: Your hair wants cutting.

ALICE: *(taken by surprise)* You should learn not to make personal remarks. It's very rude.

HATTER: Why is a raven like a writing-desk?

ALICE: I'm glad [you've] begun asking riddles! I believe I can guess that.

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MARCH HARE: Do you mean that you think you can find out the answer to it? You should say what you mean.

ALICE: I do – at least – at least I mean what I say – that's the same thing, you know.

HATTER: Not the same thing a bit! Why, you might just as well say that 'I see what I eat' is the same thing as 'I eat what I see!' . . . *(He looks at his watch uneasily, shaking it every now and then and holding it to his ear.)* What day of the month is it?

ALICE: The fourth.

HATTER: *(sighs)* Two days wrong! (begins trying to reset his watch)

ALICE: *(grabbing his wrist to look at the watch)* What a funny watch! It tells the day of the month, and doesn't tell what o'clock it is?

HATTER: *(pulling his arm back, offended)* Why should it? Does your watch tell you what year it is?

ALICE: Of course not, but that's because it stays the same year for such a long time together.

HATTER: *(Continues with his tea)* Which is just the case with mine. . . Have you guessed the riddle yet?

ALICE: No, I give it up. What's the answer?

HATTER: I haven't the slightest idea. *(he laughs)*

ALICE: *(wearily)* I think you might do something better with the time than wasting it in asking riddles that have no answers.

HATTER: If you knew Time as well as I do, you wouldn't talk about wasting IT. It's HIM. I dare say you never even spoke to Time!

ALICE: Perhaps not, but I know I have to beat time when I learn music.

HATTER: Ah! That accounts for it. He won't stand beating! . . . *(Alice stammers for a response)*

MARCH HARE: Take some more tea!

ALICE: I've had nothing yet, so I can't take more.

HATTER: You mean, you can't take less. It's very easy to take more than nothing.

ALICE: *(disgruntled)* Nobody asked your opinion.

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HATTER: Who's making personal remarks now? I want a clean cup. Let's all move one place on!

ALICE: Really, now if you ask me . . . I don't think –

HATTER: Then you shouldn't talk!

ALICE: *(Extremely offended)* [This is] the stupidest tea-party I ever was at in all my life!"

(trumpets blare)

CHAPTER VIII: The Queen's Croquet-Ground

CARD #5: The Queen! The Queen! *(Alice straightens her dress)*

QUEEN: Who is this? What's your name child?

ALICE: My name is Alice, so please your Majesty.

QUEEN: *(looks her up and down and then makes a decision)* Off with her head! Off . . .

ALICE: Nonsense!

QUEEN: Can you play croquet?

ALICE: Well . . .yes . . .

QUEEN: Well, come on then! Get to your places! *(she grabs a croquet mallet and ball and tosses the ball to Alice)*

ALICE: [This is] a flamingo and the croquet-balls [are] hedgehogs!

QUEEN: Off with her head! *(the Queen stalks away)*

ALICE: *(to herself)* They're dreadfully fond of beheading people here. *(then she notices the arrival of the Cheshire Cat)* It's the Cheshire Cat – now I shall have somebody to talk to.

CHESHIRE CAT: How do you like the Queen?

ALICE: Not at all! She's so extremely . . . *(The Queen comes up behind her, listening – Alice notices)* . . . likely to win, that it's hardly worthwhile finishing the game.

VOICE IN THE DISTANCE: The trial's beginning! *(Scene changes to the Court of Justice)*

CHAPTER XI: Who Stole the Tarts?

WHITE RABBIT: *(blows three blasts on his trumpet)* Silence in the court! *(unrolls a parchment scroll and reads)* The Queen of Hearts, she made some tarts, All on a summer day: The Knave of Hearts, he stole those tarts, And took them quite away! . . . . Alice!

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CHAPTER XII: Alice's Evidence

ALICE: *(Complete surprised)* Here!

KING: What do you know about this business?

ALICE: Nothing.

KING: Nothing whatever?

ALICE: Nothing whatever.

KING: That's very important. . . Unimportant! That proves his guilt!

ALICE: It proves nothing of the sort!

KING: Let the jury consider their verdict.

QUEEN: No, no! Sentence first – verdict afterwards

ALICE: Stuff and nonsense! The idea of having the sentence first!

QUEEN: Hold your tongue!

ALICE: I won't *(stomping her foot)*

QUEEN: Off with her head!

ALICE: *(Looking around the courtroom)* Who cares for you? You're nothing but a pack of cards!

(transition back to the scene that begins this cutting, with Alice having fallen asleep over her book -- Actor simulates the passing of time by pantomiming the movements of a clock with sound effects as Alice slowly wakes up) Oh . . . Oh . . . I've had such a curious dream!

WHITE RABBIT: Alice! *(Alice's face reacts in shock)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Lewis Carroll
ISBN: 978-0486275437
Publisher: Dover Publications
Date (Month/Year): May 1993

AWARD HISTORY

2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
IL State Qualifier

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